

Philipp Hilbert. *Product architect for custody-grade infrastructure.*

Positioning, 13 years owning regulated technical platforms, from quantum-secure encryption to defence AI, now focused on crypto custody where security constraints and product clarity must coexist.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

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Dear Hiring Team at The Vault,

I am applying for the Product Owner role on your MPC-based custody platform. The combination you are looking for, someone who can hold a credible conversation with cryptographers and security engineers, then translate that conversation into unambiguous, auditable product requirements, is the job I have been doing in adjacent regulated environments for over a decade. I want to do it where the stakes are highest: at the infrastructure layer of digital asset custody.

The clearest evidence I can offer is Qcrypt AG, the hardware-software security company I co-founded and owned as Product Owner from 2016 to 2021. The core product challenge was identical in structure to what The Vault faces: enterprise buyers would not accept complexity or opacity, but the underlying cryptography, one-time pads, true-random-number generators, quantum-resistant key management, imposed hard constraints that could not be wished away. My job was to make those constraints legible as product requirements, write acceptance criteria that held up under external audit, and ship something that installed in under two minutes without sacrificing any of the security guarantees. That is the same translation task your job description names explicitly.

At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, another environment where security posture, multinational regulatory obligations, and engineering capacity competed for the same roadmap slot. I introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD that reduced rollout time from days to 30 minutes and made the platform hotfix-capable, a concrete example of using delivery infrastructure as a product lever rather than a delivery detail. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I served as Deputy IT Security Officer while simultaneously managing a platform migration and UI relaunch, which gave me direct experience of how audit obligations and commercial goals share a backlog and sometimes conflict. At EMIL Group I took a Claims Center from concept to production with no prior precedent, compressing time-to-market for a new insurance product from many months to under a week, the kind of zero-to-one technical product delivery that a growing custody platform will need repeatedly.

Beyond my professional roles, I am a genuine long-term participant in the crypto ecosystem: eight-plus years of active use across Hyperliquid, Jupiter, Bitget, Across Protocol, and 1inch, study of liquidation mechanics, MEV, and market microstructure, and a personal infrastructure lab that includes a crypto backtesting engine, trading bots, and a multi-agent coding framework I built alone. I am not a custody-platform insider yet, and I have said so honestly in my application. But I know the product surface from the user and builder side, and the requirements engineering, security governance, and stakeholder alignment work is something I have done for regulated, technically deep products throughout my career.

The Vault's posting describes a role that sits at the centre of everything, between cryptography research, engineering, compliance, and external partners, and holds that centre through clear written specifications and sound prioritisation. That is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
